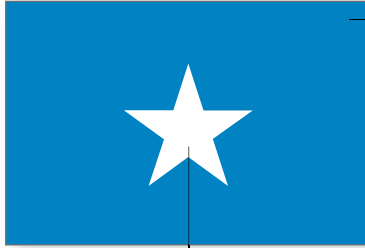


Somalia

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** October 12, 1954 **Usage:** National and Civil

The five-pointed star represents the branches of the Somali race; in Ethiopia, Kenya, Djibouti, and the former British and Italian colonies



The blue is the same as that used by the United Nations

The star of unity

Africa



Modern **Somalia** is a combination of the former Italian territory and British Somaliland. Since 1991 it has been in a state of civil war.

The flag was adopted by the Italian Trusteeship Territory in 1954 on the basis of the blue and white flag of the United Nations, which was supervising the territory at the time. It was retained when Somalia became independent in 1960. The five-pointed star is said to stand for the five branches of the Somali race

including those living in Ethiopia, Djibouti, and Kenya.

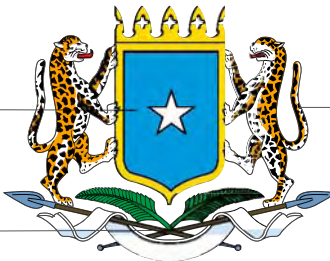
ARMS OF SOMALIA

The coat of arms was adopted in 1956. The leopards which support the shield and the white star were also found on the arms used during the Italian administration.

ARMS OF SOMALIA

The shield is based on the national flag

Below the shield are two palm branches and two spears



The supporters are leopards; a leopard also featured on the shield of the colonial arms